Worksheet A: Dissecting Questions

Name: _____ Date: _____

Task 1: Putting questions to the test

in class, pairs, 10 min.

The following questions are constructed. Choose two of them. Note what one must already believe for the question to make sense (premise), and write a version that also allows an unexpected answer.

1. Why do students learn less in lectures with a laptop than with pen and paper?
2. How strongly does the full moon influence the number of emergency admissions?
3. Which strategies do successful founders use to cope with setbacks?
4. At what age do children lose their creativity?
5. What percentage of their brain do people use in everyday life?
6. Why are women the better leaders?
7. How can the university prevent ChatGPT from destroying independent thinking?
8. How many hours of sleep does a person need to perform well?

No.	Premise(s)	More open version

Task 2: Dissecting your own question

in class, pairs, 20 min.

Write down the question you brought along. Your partner asks you the questions from the table; you note the answers. If you have no question of your own, choose a substitute topic: cafeteria food, commuting to university, learning with flashcards, part-time jobs during studies.

My question (draft):

What is presupposed?	
Which words are vague?	
What would I measure (indicator)?	
With whom, where, when?	
Which answer would surprise me?	

Task 3: SMART check

in class, pairs

Rephrase the question and tick the criteria it meets: *specific* (one object, one population, one context), *measurable* (clear which quantity is collected), *achievable* (access to data, people, material), *relevant* (the answer changes knowledge or practice), *time-bound* (feasible in the available time).

☐ specific ☐ measurable ☐ achievable ☐ relevant ☐ time-bound